Two columns, one question

The old man woke early to read,
as he did every morning exam-
ple of patience with the text,
and of quiet attention.

Words carry their sounds with
them; the reader only needs
to look underneath the line.

A second column proves the
overlay respects columns: no
sound may drift across the
gutter between two texts.

Zoom changes every distance,
yet the pairing must survive
the scaling without harm.